

International Sled Dog Racing Association

SKIJORING RULES

Amended July 2026

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Standard ISDRA Speed Race Rules and Procedures shall apply to skijoring classes with the following exceptions:

1. DRAWING

Drawing for the starting order of the skijoring class shall be by team size, three (3) dog, two (2) dog and one (1) dog. Late entries shall be added in order of receipt, regardless of the number of dogs being run. For multiple heat races, skijorers will leave the starting line in order of overall finish time of the previous heat, regardless of the number of dogs being run.

2. TEAM SIZE

Skijoring teams shall consist of a maximum of three (3) dogs and a minimum of one (1) dog.

3. EQUIPMENT

Skijoring teams must be attached via harness and tow-line to the skijorer's belt in a safe and secure manner, leaving the skijorer's hands free of the line. The line length shall be a minimum of seven (7) feet and a maximum of twelve (12) feet as measured from the skiers belt buckle to the snap on the dog's harness.

The minimum width of the skijoring belt across the back shall be three (3) inches. In the interest of safety, there must be a release device within arm's length of the skijorer.

All dogs must have a neckline attached except for a dog run in single lead position.

4. STARTING

A clearly defined starting point shall be the same for each team starting the class as determined by the RGO.

5. PASSING

Skijorers need not come to a full stop, but must slow, yield the trail and give immediate right-of-way upon demand. Once a team has been passed, that team shall not repass for two (2) minutes or one-half (1/2) mile except by mutual agreement of both drivers. Unless passing or in the no-right-a-way zone, a competitor must maintain a minimum distance of twenty (20) feet between his/her dogs and the skijorer in front.

6. FINISHING

The nose of the Lead Dog(s) shall determine the finish time of the team.

If timing is achieved by electronic device (computer chip) that is automatically read as the team passes by, the electronic device shall be located in the identical place for each competitor. The point on the trail where the electronic device is read and time taken (finish) shall be clearly identified.